Sentinel — Project Diary

Introduction to Fintech project (USI) · as of 9 November 2026

Project diary of the group: meetings, decisions and lessons learned throughout the development of Sentinel.

Meeting — 14 October 2026

Attendees. the whole group.

Topic. searching for a project idea.

Decisions. We evaluated several ideas against a double criterion: originality and feasibility within the course timeframe, working part-time. We chose to focus on the theme of security and protection of financial data, starting from the "Sentinel" proposal: a white-label service that banks integrate to intercept scams targeting the elderly (fake grandchild / fake police officer) by involving a trusted contact.

Lessons learned. In a pitch, an idea only holds if it balances originality and feasibility: a sharp, buildable idea beats an ambitious but unrealistic one for a part-time team.

Meeting — 27 October 2026

Attendees. the whole group.

Topic. strengthening the project with a quantitative component.

Decisions. We decided to add to Sentinel a quantitative study that would leverage the group's profile, grafting it where the product already required it: the detection of anomalous transactions. The engine becomes an anomaly-detection model on the customer's personal baseline; the blocking threshold is chosen by minimising the expected cost (the friction of false alarms against the loss of missed frauds), and an expected-loss-avoided model is used to justify the price to the banks.

Lessons learned. The quantitative part must be grafted where the product's structure already calls for it, not forced in; and tying the model to the business (the threshold and the price) is what sets a pitch with serious reasoning apart from a purely descriptive one.

Meeting — 6 November 2026

Attendees. the whole group.

Topic. work organisation and shared technical setup.

Decisions. We defined a guideline to split the work into independent modules, so we can develop in parallel: model and calibration, synthetic data and risk economics, interface and user experience, business and pitch. The key is decoupling: modules communicate only through functions with a stable signature, so each person can evolve their own piece without blocking the others. On the technical side we created the shared repository on GitHub and set up the branch workflow: each person works on their own branch and brings the work into main through pull requests.

Lessons learned. With a part-time team, decoupling the work with clear interfaces is what truly enables parallel progress; and the branch + pull-request flow keeps main always working and prevents everyone's changes from clashing.

Rebuttal of pitch critique

To be completed after the presentation on 17 December 2026.

Here we will collect the critiques received from the jury and our reasoned response: for each one, whether we accept it and how we would address it, or why we contest it and with what arguments. This is one of the required elements for the written deliverables (deadline mid-January).